

TANDY TRENDS™

A QUARTERLY LOOK AT PEOPLE, PLACES AND PROGRESS!



**The People, The Pride
The Products**

TANDY TRENDS
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Representatives of the Research and Development and the Computer Merchandising Departments responsible for computer product development join company executives amid the new Tandy computer product additions.

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The heartbeat of the company, Tandy Data Processing, is under the watchful eye of Carroll Leu.

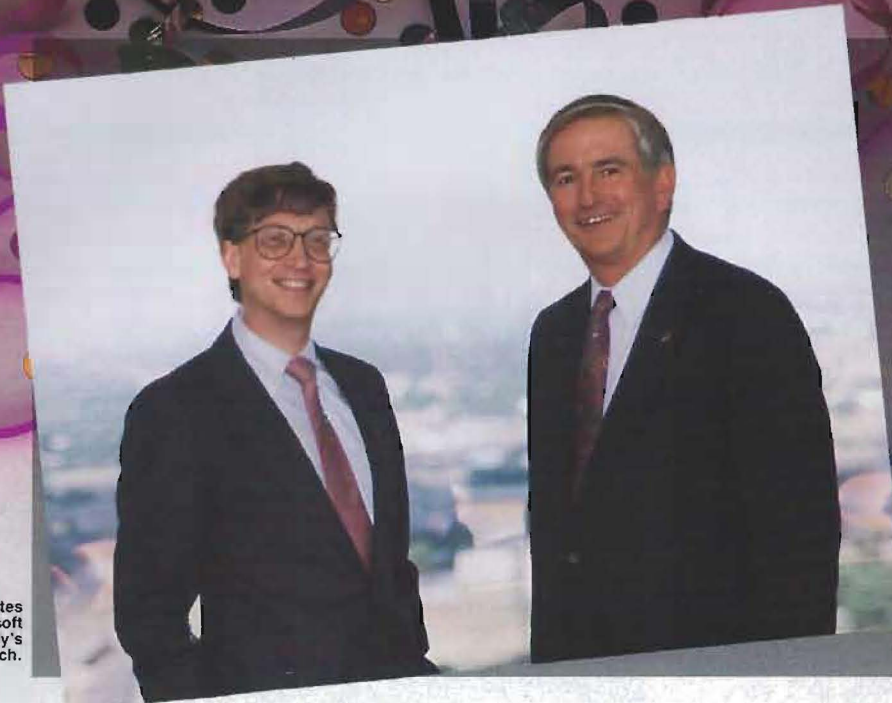


Store operations in the Northeast Division must meet the expectations of Kip Atfield.



Communication is vital to Dick Ramsey who tracks numbers reflecting corporate sales and profits.

Bill Gates
of Microsoft
and Tandy's
John Roach.



THE TENTH ANNIVERSARY of the introduction of the TRS-80 microcomputer rekindles a lot of fond memories. The TRS-80 was developed for less than \$150,000 including tooling costs. That seems like a small investment for the significant role that computer had in spawning a new industry. The low-cost development was necessary for such a high risk product in what was then an uncertain market. For example, the black and white monitor sourced from RCA was a discontinued television cabinet available in "Mercedes Grey" or "Woodgrain." We took what was available to save costs; thus, the explanation for our often-cussed grey color in later years.

Lew Kornfeld and Bernie Appel made the critical decision to build a wired, complete system rather than a kit. The market, of course, was entirely kit up to that time. Our original BASIC interpreter was written in-house as there was not much else available. The debugging of that first BASIC almost led to a delay in the introduction; but at 3 o'clock one morning—just in time—that last "bug" was found.

As the interest and momentum in the fledgling industry began to increase in the summer of 1977, we invited Bill Gates (at age 19) to offer his Microsoft BASIC as Level II BASIC for the TRS-80. Microsoft was a handful of people in those days led by Gates' dreams. The boyish Gates made an urgent trip to Fort Worth during the week of a family member's wedding to negotiate and "sell" his BASIC. His BASIC was great, as was his grasp of software; but his negotiating was a little less confident. With his one and one-half page agreement and a little negotiating, we agreed on a one-time charge. Later, when we introduced the Model III, Gates suggested that perhaps Microsoft should also receive a royalty or some additional compensation; it did. Obviously, Bill and Microsoft have been among our longest term vendors in the microcomputer area and good friends to the company.

The TRS-80 and microcomputers in general were an immediate success, but market awareness was very low. In the spring of 1978, we began a series of "barnstorming" meetings around the country to build awareness. We set up 30-50 computers in a hotel and invited the media, the financial community and the public to see and use a micro. This activity played a vital role in the rapid development of the market.

Since August 3, 1977, we've sold literally millions of computers and accessories. Thousands of jobs have been created. A whole new type of store has come into existence. The way people do typing, keep spreadsheets, and manage their information has changed. It's a new era—part of a communications and information revolution. I take pride, along with many of you, in being a part of it. May the next ten years deliver even more of the promise made possible by microprocessor technology.

John V. Roach
President, Chief Executive Officer
and Chairman of the Board,
Tandy Corporation

Lika Southwest: Putting simplicity into circuitry

Just as a microprocessor is the heart of a computer, controlling its activities and sending instructions, circuit boards provide the complex network of veins and arteries that convey the instructions along hair-thin traces of metal. As even a microscopic break in the trace can inhibit instruction execution, the production process for creating circuit boards is very exacting.

"Talking about the process is real easy," grinned Jerry Shafer, General Manager of Lika Southwest in Azle, Texas. "On the floor, though, as about 80 percent of our processing is related to chemistry, and as there are so many variables, it's never boring."

Lika Southwest is a branch of the parent Lika Corporation in Stockton, California, one of Tandy Corporation's marketing companies. In the 30,000 square foot Azle facility, some fifteen miles from Fort Worth, Lika manufactures circuit boards for the Tandy computer product line including the Tandy 1000 SX and EX and the new Tandy 1000 TX and HX computers.

In fact, the plant recently added multilayer processing capability to accommodate boards for the new

computers. Shafer explained, "With more functions and faster speeds and response times, the new computers require more and more circuitry. In order to keep the cases small and keep the weight down, the circuitry boards are compressed into a multilayer design."



General Manager, Jerry Shafer checks panels of circuit boards.

Shafer has a knack for making the task at hand sound simple. In actual fact, the manufacture of a circuit board requires a total of 27 steps including 13 major processes. According to Shafer, each step has its own in-process inspection point insuring complete and continual quality control. "We're basically a zero

defects shop," noted Shafer. "We've had no customer returns in twelve months. We're very proud of that."

A circuit board starts its life as part of a panel which is a bare piece of fiberglass laminated on each side with very thin copper foil. After numerically controlled drilling machines position the required component connection holes, the panel is sent to a 29-station electroless copper plating line that coats the interiors of the holes as well as the surface with copper approximately 70 millionths of an inch thick. This process, which requires a little over an hour to complete, metallizes the individual boards on the panel to provide a conductive path for current from one side of the board to the other. During the process, panels are put into racks for multiple processing. Computer-controlled hoists move the racks from one station to another with all 29 stations occupied simultaneously.

The panels then move to another area where they are again coated, this time with a photosensitive acid resistant material. They are exposed to ultraviolet light using a positive image film that provides the desired circuit board surface pattern. The subsequent developing

process washes the resistant material from the pattern area. The panels then undergo additional coatings with electroplated heavy copper and a tin lead composition. Then they are etched with an ammonia and chloride solution to expose the circuit traces or runs.

From this point, the panels of circuit boards move into what Shafer calls peripheral operations for the three types of processing used in the plant. "At this point, a board is about halfway through production. Depending upon a board's intended final application, it is routed through production for one of the three processes: bare copper, tin lead or tin lead with gold tips." Categorically, the plant's output runs approximately 60 percent tin lead, 30 percent bare copper and 10 percent gold tip over nickel. The latter category is used for boards that require a higher degree of durability at contact points such as memory expansion or printer interface boards for computer products.

Throughout the production process, water is a key element. It is the base for many of the coating processes as well as the various washes. "With all the chemicals we use, we run through a very high volume of water. We use about 140 gallons a minute," said Shafer. "We have a complete waste water treatment facility. We give the water back to the city cleaner than it is coming into the plant. We try to maintain all possible standards to make sure we don't pollute anything, anywhere."



In-process quality inspection is an important part of production.

In addition to the water treatment facility, the Lika plant has its own metallurgical and analysis laboratory as well as its own engineering department. "We're essentially a self-contained entity," added Shafer.

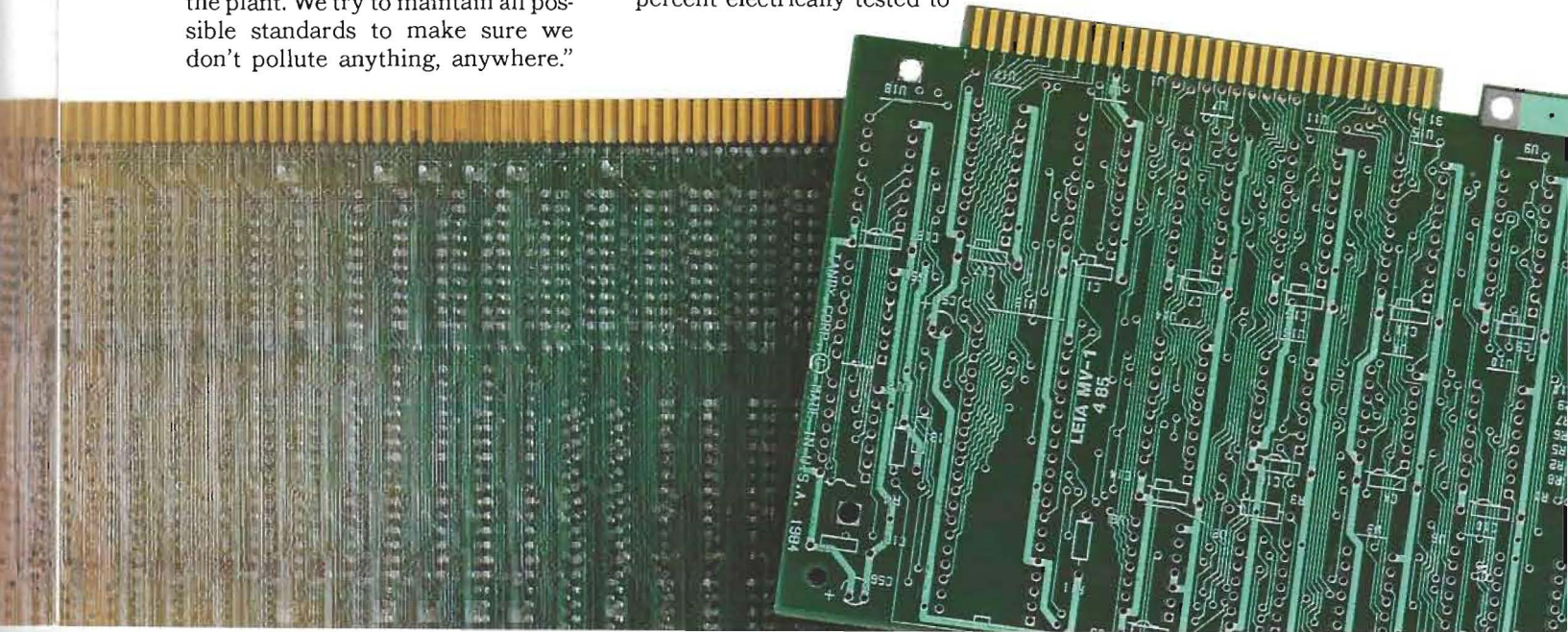
In the final stages of circuit board production, solder resist and legend characteristics such as component outlines and designations are printed on the boards. They then go into fabrication for the profiling operation where as many as 40 boards on one panel are cut to final configuration with mechanical presses and dies or with a numerically controlled router. "Some of the board shapes are quite exotic," noted Shafer. "They go from squares and circles to rectangles with all kinds of angles so they can fit into cases and around other components."

From fabrication, the boards go into final testing where they are 100 percent electrically tested to

insure there are no shorts or opens. "When they leave here, the boards are mechanically and electrically sound," Shafer emphasized. When they do leave the plant, a good percentage of the boards are shipped to other Tandy Corporation facilities including Tandy Advanced Products, Tandy Home Computers and Tandy Instruments for use in manufacturing Tandy computer products.

However, as Lika is a "job shop," a number of the finished boards are shipped to other customers. Said Shafer, "Chrysler Corporation is probably our second biggest customer. We supply boards for their auto radios and stereos as well as boards for the electronics in their turbo engine products." In fact, Lika builds as many as six boards for Chrysler with an average volume of between 300,000-700,000 of each board annually. Other customers served by Lika Southwest include Rolm Corporation and Data Race Corporation plus a number of Texas companies. Products manufactured at the facility range from small 1x2" peripheral boards to 11x18" telecommunications boards.

Looking into the future, Shafer hopes to expand production with the new multilayer capability. "We can supply additional products to our current customers and probably take on new customers as well. We could penetrate markets we have not yet seen. We're very optimistic."





Feature

Tandy computer products for 1988: Because there is no better value.™

It is interesting when a 67-year-old company celebrates a tenth birthday. On August 3, 1987, Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack celebrated ten years in the personal computer industry. To commemorate this anniversary, Radio Shack presented the 1988 Tandy personal computer product line at a press conference in New York City.

Clearly, Radio Shack and its 1988 Tandy computer product line will be leaders in the industry. Since the introduction of the TRS-80 microcomputer ten years ago, Tandy has strived for quality and value in its computer products.

These objectives were stressed in 1986 when the company was named the number one PC-compatible manufacturer by InfoCorp. Also, The Gartner Group indicated that Radio Shack held over 30 percent of the under \$500,000,000 business market at the end of 1986, while IBM's market share had dropped by nearly half.

The 1988 Tandy computer products complement our current computer product line, allowing every Radio Shack computer center to offer customers a computer solution, no matter how diverse their needs.

Dr. John Patterson
Senior Vice President
Tandy Computers

Tandy 4000: 80386 power for today and tomorrow

Based on the Intel 80386 microprocessor, the Tandy 4000 rivals mainframes and minicomputers for speed and functionality. In fact, literature on the Tandy 4000 describes performance in MIPS—a mainframe term which specifies Millions of Instructions Per Second. (The Tandy 4000 is rated at almost 3

MIPS, versus less than 1 MIPS for an 8 MHz PC AT.)

The four mode, 32-bit microprocessor allows MS-DOS software designed for the IBM PC and AT to run at a much faster 16 MHz clock speed. Additionally, when new operating systems become available, such as OS/2, the Tandy 4000 will be able to deliver the full potential of the 80386 processor.



Dr. John Patterson and the top of the 1988 computer line, the Tandy 4000.

The increased speed and memory capabilities of the Tandy 4000 make it ideal for both network and XENIX multiuser applications. The system is also ready for multitasking applications when used with appropriate software.

The Tandy 4000 is outfitted with a 1.4 megabyte, 3½" disk drive. Two additional internal disk drives can be added with any combination of 3½" drives, 5¼" drives, hard disks or disk cartridges. Incorporating single in-line memory modules (SIMM), one megabyte of memory is standard and memory is expandable to four megabytes. Using one-megabit chips, total system memory can be expanded to 16 megabytes. Six AT-style and two XT-style slots are available for further

expansion. The Tandy 4000 is the computer of the future... and the future is here today.

Tandy 1000 TX: A breakthrough price for 286 technology

With an 80286 microprocessor, the Tandy 1000 TX is destined to change the rules by which price/performance computing will be judged. With the 80286, the processing speed of a TX is over six times faster than a standard PC XT[†] and over three times faster than the IBM Model 30.

The Tandy 1000 TX is designed with a durable 3½" disk drive which can store 720,000 characters of data. A second internal 3½" disk drive or a 5¼" disk drive can be added allowing the system to be tailored to the needs of the user.

The 80286 8 MHz microprocessor runs all the popular MS-DOS programs faster than standard 8088-based PCs. The 1000 TX comes complete with MS-DOS 3.2, BASIC and Personal DeskMate 2—everything necessary to begin computing. Personal DeskMate 2 features pull-down menus and "dialogue boxes" that make selecting operations easy, a new Music program and Paint function, in addition to text, spreadsheet, database and calendar programs.

The Tandy 1000 TX comes standard with 640K RAM. Five card slots make it easy to expand with an internal modem, a 20-meg hard disk card, or even a card for connecting to a workgroup environment. Adding even more value to the package, the TX includes many additional features that cost extra on other PCs—monochrome and color graphics, a parallel printer port, two joystick ports, a headphone jack with volume control and a built-in RS-232C serial port.

[†]Comparison based on Norton Utilities Computing Index Version 4.0, XT/TM IBM Corp.

Tandy 1000 HX: No more loading MS-DOS from disk

The innovative spirit behind Tandy computers is evident in the Tandy 1000 HX, the first desktop computer designed for home or educational use with MS-DOS in ROM built-in. When powered on, MS-DOS is loaded automatically and is ready to run in just seconds. This ease of operation in addition to its low cost make the Tandy 1000 HX ideal for use in the home or classroom.

The 1000 HX has a number of features including 256K RAM, a 3½" 720K disk drive and room for a second 3½" internal disk drive. For maximum flexibility, the HX also

Tandy 1400 LT: MS-DOS power in a portable computer

MS-DOS compatibility is only the beginning for the Tandy 1400 LT laptop computer. Because it's portable, today's most popular software programs can be used virtually anywhere, making it perfect for busy executives, salespeople, journalists and other on-the-go professionals. In the office, the Tandy 1400 LT is as powerful and functional as a desktop computer. To make "getting started" easier and more economical, MS-DOS and GW-BASIC are included at no extra cost.

One of the most notable features of the 1400 LT is its display. While many other laptops have standard

compatible laptops. The 1400 LT includes adapters for an RGBI or Composite monitor, an RS-232 serial device, a parallel printer and an external keyboard. Despite its impressive capabilities, the 1400 LT weighs only 13½ pounds and has a convenient carry handle for true portable computing power.

Tandy LP 1000: Affordable desktop publishing is here

As part of a complete desktop publishing package or as an addition to existing computer hardware, the LP 1000 laser printer makes any printed computer output sharper and clearer, providing a more professional appearance. Now, even spreadsheets and word processing can be produced with near typeset quality at a fraction of the cost of professional typesetting.

When used with one of the many desktop publishing software packages, the LP 1000 produces laser-sharp originals using a combination of both text and graphics. With all its features, the LP 1000 is designed to make printing possibilities almost unlimited.

In addition to desktop publishing, the LP 1000 is compatible with industry standard software packages allowing typeset quality printing of all types of computer output.

Portrait and landscape modes allow the handling of a variety of printing jobs. Users may select resident fonts and two downloadable custom software fonts. Or, they may select the graphics mode offering 300×300 dots per inch on a full page. The LP 1000 operates quietly while handling jobs such as newsletters and brochures—correspondence that once had to be contracted outside—at a rate of up to six pages per minute.

The Tandy LP 1000 includes a controller board as a standard feature as well as 1.5 megabytes of memory for full page graphics—a welcome alternative to high priced "extras." Included in this standard controller are emulations for Tandy, IBM Proprinter, IBM Wheelprinter and the HP Laser Jet Plus.



The Tandy LP 1000 laser printer produces up to six razor-sharp copies per minute.

supports an external 5¼" disk drive. Also included is a three-voice sound circuit for generating music, and a headphone jack with volume control.

The PC-compatible Tandy 1000 HX runs all the popular MS-DOS software programs. The Tandy 1000 HX comes with MS-DOS, GW-BASIC and Personal DeskMate 2, an integrated seven-in-one software package that includes productivity applications.

Following in the tradition of all Tandy 1000s, the HX offers conveniences that cost extra on other PCs. Adapters for joysticks, monochrome and color monitors and a printer are included on the Tandy 1000 HX.

Liquid Crystal Displays (LCD), the 1400 LT's 80-character by 25-line display utilizes the latest backlit "supertwist" LCD technology for sharp resolution and easier reading in low light.

A removable, rechargeable battery pack allows up to four hours of continuous use. A battery low LED indicator gives ample time to save data. And, optional spare battery packs drop in to allow computing without interruption.

The 1400 LT comes with two 720K 3½" disk drives which provide over 1.4 megabytes of disk capacity. The 1400 LT also comes with 768K RAM, and runs at a fast 7.16 MHz clock speed. That's 50 percent faster than most other PC-

Close-up

"Today you've really got to know products and sales techniques in order to get your share of the market."

Success on the fast track has always characterized Jim Nichols' career with Radio Shack. In less than twenty years he has risen from a manager trainee to the Senior Vice President of Retail Operations, Consumer Division, USA. His title might be a mouthful, but his record of successes speaks for itself.

After leaving the Navy in 1968, Nichols became a manager trainee. He was a store manager the next year and a district manager two and a half years later.

In December, 1973, Nichols was once again promoted, this time to the newly-created position of Atlanta regional manager which at the time encompassed nearly seven states. The company was growing so quickly that new positions were constantly being created. When the country was divided into five geographical divisions in 1975, Nichols was named to serve as one of five divisional vice presidents.

According to Nichols, the divisional posts were created as a method for training management to run the company's overseas operations, an assignment he readily accepted in 1979, when he became Managing Director of the United Kingdom. After two years, Nichols returned to the United States as divisional vice president of the southeast division. In 1984, his overseas experience was recognized in a promotion to Senior Vice President of Tandy International Electronics



*James Nichols, Senior Vice President
Retail Operations, Consumer Division, USA.*

with responsibility for all of the overseas operations with the exception of Australia.

Nichols' record of successes is unquestionably impressive. Since taking on his current position in 1985, he has used the experience of nineteen years, and the understanding of where Radio Shack has been, to create a vision of where Radio Shack is headed.

As the company prepares to enter the 1990s, Nichols recognizes the need to grow with the times. He indicated that while the company will continue to expand between 50 and 100 stores annually, "Our big push now has to be on average volume per location. Ultimately, our goal is to increase the yearly average volume per store from the present half a million dollars per store to a million dollars."

According to Nichols, the expansion of the merchandise line with higher ticket goods will help to realize the goal of a million dollar average. "Carrying higher ticket merchandise creates a situation where everybody has to be a much better salesmaker than in the past," cautioned Nichols. "Today you've really got to know products and sales techniques in order to get your share of the market."

Toward enhancing professionalism, an increased emphasis has been placed on sales training which Nichols said is "getting to be a big part of all of our jobs. We're trying to focus more on sales and sales training, than operations and opening new stores."

Nichols spelled out what he thinks is the key to a successful career in retailing. "To be successful, you've got to have a commitment to be a winner and the desire to be seen as a professional salesperson. And, you've got to do a lot of homework, but I think that's only natural for any good professional.

"Hopefully, everybody is in as big a hurry to reach the million dollar average store level as I am. When all of our employees have that image of themselves as professionals, we will get the kind of volume we are looking for and make the kind of advances that we want to make."

Judging from Jim Nichols' past successes, those advances can't be far away.

Profile



Carroll D. Leu

"I came to Tandy Corporation from an 8-to-5 job. The environment here was a total culture shock. I hadn't known that people worked as hard as they do here!"

But don't be fooled by this comic vignette. Carroll Leu, Vice President, Tandy Data Processing, is no stranger to hard work; and, he approaches it with style and a sense of humor.

Leu and his 325 full-time data processing personnel are responsible for all data processing for Tandy Corporation and its various divisions including Radio Shack, Tandy Name Brands, Tandy Electronics and Tandy Electronics, Inc.

"We are probably in the best position to really understand the corporation because we do work for everybody. We work with anyone within Tandy Corporation who has any need for our services," related Leu, noting that the heavy users are accounting, advertising, distribution/merchandising, manufacturing and Tandy Name Brands.

Data Processing also utilizes 200 in-home typists to do mailing list data entry. These individuals process about 6.5 million names and addresses each month.

"The job has just gotten bigger over the years," reflected Leu, who

has watched the company and his department grow since 1966 when he joined the department as operations manager. "It's a neat deal to see a company grow," said Leu. "There's no magic; just hard work."

While it may not be magic, Leu definitely emanates an aura that translates to a straight forward approach to getting the job done. Besides, he just plain relates well to people. Maybe that's why there is so much tenure among the staff.

"A high percentage of our people have been here over five years and we have a lot who have been here fifteen. All of the managers have been here at least thirteen years. We've done a good job of retaining computer people."

There is no doubt that the data processing staff is a point of pride for Leu. "We have outstanding people, talented people; no question. One of the biggest job satisfactions is being able to see the growth, not only of the company, but also of the people we have hired over the years and how they have grown.

"I take a lot of pride in being able to promote everybody from within. That's the type of corporation that

"I just feel like a very lucky person to be with Tandy. I stumbled into a great career."

Tandy is. I feel very fortunate to have been a little part of it."

When he's not working, which is seldom, Leu enjoys "gardening and stuff like that." A native of Arkansas, he is also drawn to fishing; but, he bemoans, talks about it more than he participates.

"I just feel like a very lucky person to be with Tandy. I stumbled into a great career," Leu beamed.

On the other hand, Tandy is a lucky company to have the likes of Carroll Leu; no question.



Clifford 'Kip' Atfield

Name a company where someone can start out as a "paid out of petty cash employee" and end up twenty-three years later as a vice president. Answer: Radio Shack.

"I never really intended to be with Radio Shack back then," reflected Clifford "Kip" Atfield, Divisional Vice President, Northeast Division. "I started working part-time during high school and continued into college. My aspirations were to go out and become a professional in the business world."

After his plans were interrupted by a stint in the U.S. Army, Atfield returned to Radio Shack on a full-time basis in 1968 and became manager of a store in Orange, Connecticut. Atfield's aggressive, take-charge attitude soon earned him a series of district manager posts, and culminated in his appointment as the regional manager for southern California, Nevada and Arizona in 1978.

Two years later, he moved to corporate headquarters as Divisional Vice President for the Southeast Division and was instrumental in opening the company's operations in Puerto Rico.

Profile

In 1982, Atfield began a three year tour in Brussels, Belgium with responsibility for company stores in Holland, Germany, Belgium and France and the dealer program throughout a number of European Economic Community (EEC) and other countries. He returned to Fort Worth in 1985, taking his current post.

"There is definitely opportunity in this company," Atfield stressed. "In fact, there's probably more opportunity now, for the people just starting out, than there was when I was a part-timer. That's logical because the company is bigger and more substantial. Therefore, it offers a much broader scope.

"We offer a very strong career path that was not necessarily available twenty years ago. There are thousands of opportunities. There is also great opportunity to put together a substantial net worth."

Atfield views the company's growth as a three part formula: Individual opportunity, merchandise and advertising. "Desirable merchandise, an ad program that builds store traffic and an entrepreneurial attitude comprise a very workable

"There's probably more opportunity now, for the people just starting out, than when I was a part-timer."

and unique combination for us. I'm not familiar with any retailer in the nation today that operates under our philosophy."

Speaking of philosophy, Atfield believes that the people who succeed are motivators who have the ability to generate excitement in the people around them.

"You won't hear them say 'that's impossible'. They try again or look for new ways with persistence. They rally the team around them and they go forward."

They are men like Kip Atfield.



Dick Ramsey

Twenty years ago, Dick Ramsey was a full-time accounting student and a part-time Tandy Corporation employee. Today, he is the Vice President and Controller for Tandy Corporation. "Tandy helped me get through graduate school from a financial view point," Ramsey said with a smile. "I guess they've been helping me ever since."

While the numbers that represent the sales and profits of the corporation's many divisions are the basis of his work, it is the communication of those numbers in a fashion usable to nonaccounting personnel that is his goal.

"I like to think of accounting as not just numbers sitting on a page," Ramsey said. "Most of our accountants are involved in day-to-day operations. We want them to work closely with management so they can do their own jobs better and can help managers understand the numbers, read financial statements and improve their operations."

Communication and cooperation are two words with a special meaning for Ramsey. Through his wide and varied experiences within the company, including positions in retail and manufacturing accounting and as the Vice President of North

American Manufacturing, Ramsey has learned the inner workings of Tandy Corporation. He has also learned that the channels of communication are opened through cooperation.

Cooperation between accounting and data processing has led to greater communication company-wide. The development and refinement of management information, a distillation of accounting numbers into usable data, is a case in point. "We have one of the finest data processing departments in the country," Ramsey willingly noted. "Our relationship with data processing and the coordination between us is the key to the overall success of the accounting departments and management information."

The offspring of this cooperation, and the backbone of information gathering, is the Radio Shack SOS system. By the beginning of each business day, the previous day's sales information has been processed and distributed to management. "I don't know of any company our size that has that much information as readily available, particularly on a daily basis," Ramsey said.

"I don't know of any company our size that has as much information as readily available."

"No one missed having this information until they had it and now, we can't live without it."

As the overseer for all Tandy Corporation accounting functions, Ramsey stresses communication. "John Roach used to say that if you're aware of a problem, you're part of the problem. When accountants and controllers see problems, it's their job to bring those problems to somebody's attention," Ramsey stressed. "Communication is the key to our continued success. It has to be emphasized at all times, and everybody realizes the importance of it."

Live from New York and Dallas... the new 1988 Tandy computer products!

August 3, 1987 was a big day for Radio Shack. The company celebrated its ten years in the computer industry by introducing its 1988 line of Tandy computer products at the Waldorf Astoria Hotel in New York. For the first time in its history of product announcements, Radio Shack shared the excitement firsthand

with field personnel. Using video teleconferencing and satellite technology, executives of Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack were telecast to personnel attending annual meetings of the Business Products Division in Dallas, Texas, and the Western Division, Consumer Products, in Anaheim, California.

